

Template: a visual guide

Your name

Your team or organisation

Presentation date

1. Browse this PDF to find the layout you want.
2. Search for that slide title in `slides.tex`.
3. Copy its complete `frame`, then replace the content.
4. Delete the tutorial slides and compile your presentation.

One source file contains the guide and every example.

Build locally with `make` or the VS Code build task.
In Overleaf, select `slides.tex` and the pdfLaTeX compiler.

The four fields above the document set the cover text.

Use `\and` between authors. The organisation belongs in `\institute`.

Call `\maketitle` outside a frame. It creates the burgundy cover and excludes it from the slide count.

```
\title{Your project title}  
\author{Alex Lee \and Sam Chen}  
\institute{Your organisation}  
\date{3 October 2026}  
  
\begin{document}  
\maketitle  
% Your frames go here.  
\end{document}
```

Replace the `\titlegraphic` block near the top of this file. Keep the image height smaller than the white strip (16 mm).

```
\titlegraphic{%  
  \includegraphics[width=0.52\linewidth,height=10mm,  
    keepaspectratio]{assets/left-logo.png}%  
  \hfill  
  \includegraphics[width=0.30\linewidth,height=10mm,  
    keepaspectratio]{assets/right-logo.png}%  
}
```

Use your own files at these paths. Keep only one image for a single logo, or remove the block for an empty strip. The supplied starter checks for missing files with `\IfFileExists`.

1. Start here

Sections populate the contents and the header. A section command does not create a slide.

2. Layouts

```
\section[Short name]{Full name}
\begin{frame}{Contents}
  \tableofcontents
```

3. Evidence

```
\end{frame} % End slide
```

4. Presenting

An optional divider:

```
\begin{frame}[plain,noframenumbering]
  \sectionpage
\end{frame} % End slide
```

5. Theme

A short sentence establishes the context.

- Explain the problem.
- Introduce the evidence.

State the main point.

```
\begin{frame}{Your slide title}  
  A short opening sentence.  
  \begin{itemize}  
    \item Explain the problem.  
    \item Introduce the evidence.  
  \end{itemize}  
  \takeaway{State the main point.}  
\end{frame} % End slide
```

Text beside another element

Use columns for a comparison, a figure with commentary, or a worked example beside its code.

Widths that add up to less than 1 leave a gutter. Inside a column, `\linewidth` is the column width.

```
\begin{columns}[T,onlytextwidth]
  \begin{column}{0.44\textwidth}
    Left-hand content.
  \end{column}
  \begin{column}{0.50\textwidth}
    Right-hand content.
  \end{column}
\end{columns}
```

Problem / Research gap

Existing evaluations use data from a single site.

Solution / Answer

Evaluate on a held-out site using the same protocol.

Research question / Goal

Does the method work at an unseen site?

Key finding / Takeaway

State the supported result and its main limitation.

Illustrative research narrative. Use burgundy for general highlights, key findings, takeaways, and conclusions.

Problem

Describe what is missing.

```
\begin{colorblock}[orange]{Problem}  
  Describe what is missing.  
\end{colorblock}
```

Key finding

State the main result.

```
\begin{colorblock}{Key finding}  
  State the main result.  
\end{colorblock}
```

Choose orange, turquoise, darkblue, or burgundy. Omit the colour for burgundy.

The colour changes only this block. Keep the title descriptive so readers can understand its role without relying on colour.

```
1 public class Hello {  
2     public static void main(String[] args) {  
3         // A short greeting  
4         String name = "Ada";  
5         System.out.println("Hello, " + name);  
6     }  
7 }
```

Output: Hello, Ada

Use a [fragile] frame and place your code inside:

```
\begin{lstlisting}[language=Java]  
// Paste your Java code here.  
\end{lstlisting}
```

Keywords, **strings**, and *comments* have distinct styles.

Change the language option to highlight another language.

SECTION 03

Evidence

Your chart, photograph, or diagram

A caption or credit belongs beside its figure.

Replace the placeholder with:

```
\includegraphics[  
  width=\linewidth,  
  height=3.1cm,  
  keepaspectratio  
{assets/figure.pdf}  
\source{Caption and credit.}
```

Use PDF, PNG, or JPG. The width and height are limits; keepaspectratio prevents stretching.

A figure across the slide

A wide figure placeholder, represented by a light gray rectangular box.

A wide figure

A concise caption helps the audience read the figure.

```
\figureplaceholder[2.8cm]{A wide figure}  
\source{A concise caption.}
```

120

Observations

18%

Relative change

4

Study groups

Explain what the measures establish.

```
\metric{120}{Observations}    % Put each metric in a column.  
\takeaway{Explain what the measures establish.}
```

Illustrative values only. Replace with your own evidence and units.

Method	Score
Baseline	0.72
Alternative	0.83

Illustrative values only.

The theme includes booktabs for clean horizontal rules.

```
\begin{tabular}{@{}lr@{}}
\toprule
\textbf{Method} & \textbf{Score} \\
\midrule
Baseline & 0.72 \\
Alternative & \alert{0.83} \\
\bottomrule
\end{tabular}
```

$$\hat{y} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x$$

x An observed input

$\hat{y}$ A predicted response

A simple model for demonstration.

```
\[
  \hat{y} = \beta_0
    + \beta_1 x
\]
\begin{description}
  \item[$x$] An observed input
  \item[$\hat{y}$] A predicted response
\end{description}
```

Ordinary LaTeX math works here. Beamer supplies AMS math support.

Add a credit next to the material it describes, or cite a numbered reference [1].

Source: your dataset, author, year.



Author Name. Work title. Venue, year.

This is a placeholder reference.

```
\source{Source: author, year.}  
A claim~\cite{demo}.
```

```
\begin{thebibliography}{9}  
  \bibitem{demo} Author Name.  
    \emph{Work title}. Venue, year.  
\end{thebibliography}
```

Compile twice to resolve citations. No separate bibliography file or processor is needed.

1. State the question.

```
\begin{enumerate}[<+>]  
  \item State the question.  
  \item Show the evidence.  
  \item Give the conclusion.  
\end{enumerate}
```

This example uses three PDF pages. The frame number stays the same. Add `handout` to the document class options to combine the reveals into one page.

1. State the question.
2. Show the evidence.

```
\begin{enumerate}[<+>]  
  \item State the question.  
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```

This example uses three PDF pages. The frame number stays the same. Add `handout` to the document class options to combine the reveals into one page.

Add a note inside any frame, or immediately after `\maketitle`:

```
\note{Explain why this choice matters to the audience.}
```

Notes are hidden by default. To include them, add these lines before `\begin{document}`:

```
\setbeameroption{show notes}  
\setbeamertemplate{note page}[plain]
```

Use `show only notes` for a notes-only PDF, or remove the option to return to the normal presentation.

Phase 1 Prepare the inputs.

Phase 2 Test the method.

Phase 3 Share the findings.

Name the next milestone.

```
\begin{description}
  \item[Phase 1] Prepare the inputs.
  \item[Phase 2] Test the method.
  \item[Phase 3] Share the findings.
\end{description}
\takeaway{Name the next milestone.}
```

A closing slide

Presenting

Your main conclusion in one sentence

State the next step or the feedback you want from the audience.

Questions and discussion

Your name `you@example.org`

Orange	DA3A16
Turquoise	057D78
Dark blue	004085
Burgundy	7A003C

Ink	222222
Muted text	666666
Paper	FFFFFF

Edit these definitions in
`beamerCommon.sty`.

Original burgundy; other accents: Concordia University web colour palette. Research categories are this template's convention.

Burgundy is the default for blocks, the cover, headings, and takeaways:

```
\definecolor{burgundy}  
  {HTML}{7A003C}
```

Use six hexadecimal digits without a hash. A coloured block keeps the same typography and spacing for every research role.

`\alert{words}` provides **burgundy emphasis** within a sentence.

Theme length	Default
<code>\templateMargin</code>	10 mm
<code>\templateTopInset</code>	5 mm
<code>\templateFooterInset</code>	5 mm
<code>\templateTitleGap</code>	3 mm
<code>\templateSectionWidth</code>	28 mm
<code>\templateLogoBarHeight</code>	16 mm

Edit lengths in
beamerthemeTemplate.sty; fonts in
beamerCommon.sty:

```
\setlength{\templateTopInset}{5mm}  
\setbeamerfont{frametitle}{size=\Large}
```

The document class sets the base size (11 pt) and aspect ratio. Shared fonts also apply to the poster.

After a layout change, inspect long titles, columns, and figures. Shorten content before shrinking the text.

Literal characters Write `\%`, `\&`, `\_`, `\#`, and `\$` in ordinary text.

Code on a slide Use `\begin{frame}[fragile]{Title}`.

Long section name Use `\section[Short]{Full name}`.

Missing totals or citations Compile twice; `make` does this.

Text or figures overflow Shorten, split the slide, or reduce figure height.

Compilation fails Start with the first error in `slides.log`.

To create your own deck, keep the preamble and the frames you need. Replace this guide's content and keep both style files beside `slides.tex`.